

1. Overview

The AquaFlow 200 is a countertop water filter pitcher with a 2.5 liter capacity and a replaceable 3-stage carbon filter cartridge. It removes chlorine taste and odor, sediment, and reduces trace levels of lead and mercury. Each filter cartridge is rated for approximately 150 liters or two months of typical household use, whichever comes first. The pitcher is designed for indoor countertop or refrigerator-door use. It ships in three color options - clear, slate gray, and sage green - which are cosmetically identical and use the same replacement cartridge. The AquaFlow 200 replaced the earlier AquaFlow 150 model in the product lineup; the two models use different cartridge shapes and are not cross-compatible, so confirm the pitcher model printed on the base before ordering replacement filters.

2. Setup Instructions

Before first use, remove the filter cartridge from its plastic wrapping and soak it in cold water for 15 minutes. Rinse the cartridge under running tap water for 30 seconds to clear any loose carbon dust. Insert the cartridge into the funnel housing until it clicks into place. Run two full pitcher cycles of tap water through the filter and discard this water before drinking any filtered water, as the first cycles may contain residual carbon fines. Unpack the pitcher body, lid, and reservoir separately and rinse each part with warm water before assembly - manufacturing residue from packaging is common and is not a defect. Assemble the reservoir on top of the pitcher body so the four corner tabs align with the pitcher's rim notches; the reservoir should sit flush without rocking. If the reservoir rocks after assembly, the tabs are misaligned and should be reseated before adding water.

3. Daily Operation

Fill the upper reservoir with tap water up to the marked fill line. Do not use water from an unregulated well or water that has not been tested for microbiological safety, as the AquaFlow 200 is not certified to remove bacteria or viruses. A full reservoir takes approximately 8 to 10 minutes to filter completely into the lower pitcher. The lower pitcher holds 2.5 liters. Do not force the reservoir lid closed while filtering is in progress, as this can cause overflow. For best taste, store the filled pitcher in the refrigerator rather than at room temperature; filtered water is not chemically preserved and should be consumed within 5 days of filtering. The pitcher's spout has a built-in drip guard - lift it fully open before pouring to avoid a slow, uneven stream. The lid can remain closed while pouring; there is no need to remove the reservoir to serve water from the lower pitcher.

4. Filter Replacement

The filter status indicator on the lid turns from green to red when replacement is due. To replace the cartridge, twist it counterclockwise a quarter turn and lift it out of the funnel housing. Dispose of the old cartridge according to local recycling guidelines; do not puncture or burn it. Follow the same soak-and-rinse procedure from Section 2 for the new cartridge before reinserting it. Reset the status indicator by holding the reset button on the lid for 3 seconds until it blinks green twice. Genuine AquaFlow 200 replacement cartridges are sold in single, 3-pack, and 6-pack quantities under the model code AF200-CART. Third-party cartridges marketed as "universal fit" are not endorsed and may not seat correctly in the funnel housing, which can cause unfiltered water to bypass the cartridge around its edges. If the status indicator flashes red and green alternately rather than showing solid red, this indicates the cartridge is not seated correctly rather than that replacement is due - reseal it before resetting the indicator.

5. Cleaning and Maintenance

Wash the pitcher, lid, and reservoir by hand with warm water and mild dish soap every two weeks. Do not use abrasive scouring pads, as they can scratch the plastic and harbor bacteria. The pitcher body is not dishwasher safe; the lid and reservoir top rack are dishwasher safe. Never immerse the filter cartridge itself in soapy water. Wipe the cartridge housing with a damp cloth only. If mineral scale builds up on the reservoir's mesh screen, soak the reservoir alone (with the cartridge removed) in a solution of one part white vinegar to four parts water for 15 minutes, then rinse thoroughly before reassembly. Do not use bleach or other chlorine-based cleaners anywhere on the unit, as chlorine residue can degrade the carbon cartridge's filtering capacity on the next use.

6. Troubleshooting

If water filters slower than usual, the cartridge may be nearing the end of its life or may be clogged with sediment; try rinsing it under running water for one minute. If filtered water has a plastic taste after setup, repeat the two discard cycles described in Section 2. If the status indicator does not light up at all, check that the two AAA batteries in the lid compartment are inserted with correct polarity. If water leaks from the base, confirm the lower pitcher is fully seated and the gasket ring is not twisted. If filtered water appears cloudy immediately after a new cartridge is installed, this is typically trapped air escaping the carbon block and should clear within the first one or two filtering cycles; it is not a sign of contamination. If the reservoir drains unusually fast (under 5 minutes for a full fill), inspect the cartridge for a cracked housing, which allows water to bypass the filtering media entirely - a cracked cartridge should be replaced immediately rather than reused.

7. Safety Warnings

Do not use hot or carbonated water in the AquaFlow 200; it is rated for cold tap water only, between 4 and 30 degrees Celsius. Keep the unit out of direct sunlight to prevent algae growth in the reservoir. This product is not a substitute for emergency water disinfection during a boil-water advisory. Keep small parts, including the filter cartridge wrapping, away from children. The pitcher body and reservoir are made of BPA-free polypropylene rated for repeated food contact; however, they are not rated for use with carbonated beverages, as pressure buildup can crack the lower pitcher. Do not place the pitcher near open flame or on a stovetop - the polypropylene body will deform starting around 100 degrees Celsius.

8. Technical Specifications

Overall dimensions: 24 cm height, 14 cm width, 20 cm depth. Empty weight: 480 grams. Full weight (upper and lower reservoirs combined): approximately 3.4 kilograms. Cartridge dimensions: 10 cm height, 6 cm diameter. Cartridge media: three stages - activated coconut-shell carbon, ion-exchange resin, and a 0.5-micron sediment mesh, in that order from inlet to outlet. Flow rate: approximately 250 milliliters per minute when the cartridge is new, decreasing to roughly 150 milliliters per minute near the end of the cartridge's rated life. Status indicator battery: two AAA alkaline batteries, rated for approximately 12 months of typical use before replacement.

9. Materials and Environmental Information

The pitcher body, lid, and reservoir are manufactured from polypropylene (recycling code 5). The cartridge housing is polypropylene; the internal carbon and resin media are not intended to be separated by the consumer and should be disposed of as a sealed unit through local recycling or household waste programs, depending on regional guidelines. The cartridge does not contain any battery, electronic component, or heavy metal beyond the trace contaminants it has adsorbed from use, so it does not require battery or e-waste disposal channels. Packaging materials (outer box, inner tray, cartridge wrap) are cardboard and low-density polyethylene, both widely recyclable through standard curbside programs in most regions.

10. Frequently Asked Questions

Can I use the AquaFlow 200 with sparkling or carbonated water? No - see Section 7; carbonation can crack the lower pitcher and is outside the unit's rated use. Does filtering remove fluoride? No. The AquaFlow 200's ion-exchange stage is tuned for chlorine taste/odor and trace lead/mercury reduction; it is not certified for fluoride reduction, and fluoride levels in filtered water will be effectively unchanged from tap water. Can the cartridge be recharged or refilled at home? No - the cartridge is a sealed, single-use unit. Attempting to open or refill it voids correct operation and is not supported. How do I know which model I have if the base label is worn off? The AquaFlow 200's reservoir has four corner alignment tabs (Section 2); the older AquaFlow 150 has only two. This is the fastest way to tell them apart without a legible label. Is a squeaking sound during filtering normal? A faint squeak during the first few uses of a new cartridge is normal air-release noise and should stop after one or two cycles; a persistent loud squeak may indicate the cartridge is not fully seated - see Section 4. Can I travel with the pitcher filled? The unit is not designed to be carried while full; the reservoir lid is not watertight under tilting or inversion. Empty the reservoir before moving the pitcher any significant distance, and keep the lower pitcher upright at all times. Why does my water taste slightly different between the first and last glass from a full pitcher? Filtration continues gradually as water sits in the lower pitcher, so water drawn later in a cycle has typically been in contact with the cartridge's residual filtering capacity slightly longer; this is a normal, minor variation and not a sign of malfunction.

11. Compatibility and Accessories

The AquaFlow 200 is compatible with the AquaFlow-branded fridge-door insert (sold separately, model AF200-FDI), which lets the pitcher sit flush inside standard refrigerator door bins without tipping. It is not compatible with the AquaFlow 150's countertop stand, since the two models have different base footprints. An optional TDS (total dissolved solids) test strip kit, model AF200-TDS, is available for households that want to spot-check filtered water quality between cartridge changes. This is a convenience accessory only; the AquaFlow 200's certified reduction claims (Section 1) do not depend on using the TDS kit, and a rising TDS reading is not by itself proof that the cartridge needs replacement - use the status indicator (Section 4) as the primary replacement signal. A silicone splash guard, model AF200-SG, fits over the reservoir fill opening to reduce splashing when pouring water in quickly from a tap or jug. It is dishwasher safe on the top rack, same as the lid and reservoir.

12. Water Quality and Testing Reference

Independent lab testing referenced in this manual was conducted using NSF/ANSI 42 and 53 protocol methodology for chlorine taste/odor and lead/mercury reduction claims respectively, using representative municipal tap water spiked to standard challenge concentrations. Actual reduction performance in a given household depends on source water composition, cartridge age, and flow rate, and may vary from lab conditions. The AquaFlow 200 is not certified for and should not be relied upon to remove: bacteria, viruses, parasitic cysts (such as *Cryptosporidium* or *Giardia*), nitrates, arsenic, or PFAS/PFOA compounds. Households on private well water or under a boil-water advisory should use a certified disinfection method in addition to, not instead of, this pitcher - see the safety warning in Section 7. Typical municipal tap water hardness does not affect the carbon and ion-exchange stages' rated lifespan under normal conditions; however, households with unusually hard water (above 180 mg/L as calcium carbonate) may notice the mesh screen cleaning interval in Section 5 needs to be shortened from every two weeks to weekly.